



Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

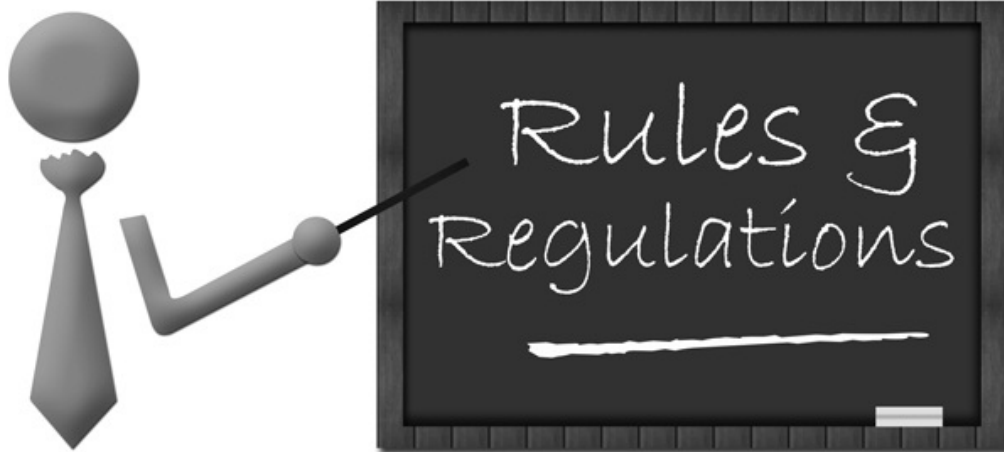
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Let's Start!

Pronunciation Spot: We have a policy for that.



Learning Outcome

Analyze issues relating to different topics and their solution in written and spoken situations according to work and social contexts.

Can Do Statements

- I can explain a work policy.
- I can talk about expectations for the future.
- I can know what sounds make up the words.

Ask your partner:

- A "company policy" is a set of rules that employees are supposed to follow at work. What are some policies you have to follow at work?
- What policies do you not agree with? Why?





Let's Explore!

Denise Moore gives Adam and Kristi an **orientation session*** at their new workplace. She hopes the transition will go **smoothly and seamlessly****.

* In an "orientation session", a manager explains how things work to a new employee.

** "Smoothly and seamlessly" is a common expression meaning easy, without problems.

Instructions: Read the text aloud.

Denise: Good morning, I'm Denise Moore, CEO of BFP Publishing.

Adam: Pleased to meet you, I'm Adam Bari.

Kristi: And I'm Kristi Lenard.

Denise: Welcome to BFP Publishing. My job will be to make sure your transition goes as smoothly and seamlessly as possible. Please, take this chair. We share furniture around here.

Adam: So far, we're off to a great start.

Denise: Three people will share this office space. You have a lovely view of the tree outside. Now, I'd like to have a little tête-à-tête about some company policies so you know exactly what is expected from you. Let's start by talking about what it means to be reliable.

Kristi: Sure.

Denise: We want to build a trusting work environment. We don't want to always ask for updates. The counterpart of that means that you ought to be very reliable. Our industry is all about deadlines, and of course, we strive to produce top quality publications. We also expect you to be honest about your progress.

Adam: I agree 100%.

Denise: Next, we should talk about establishing an appropriate work schedule. For us, that means being punctual, usually arriving no later than 9:00 a.m. There may be some flexibility, but as a rule of thumb, arriving after 9:00 should be the exception rather than the rule. Most employees don't leave before 5:00 p.m.

Adam: That's great.

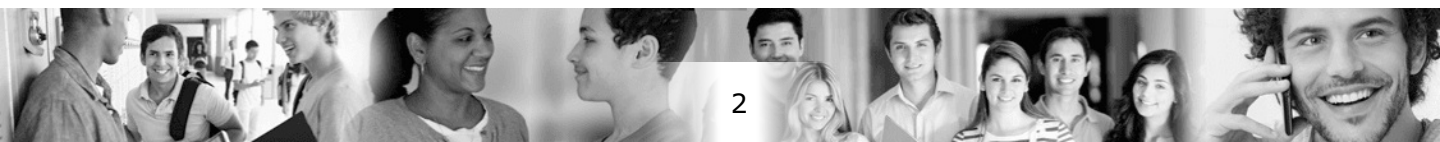
Denise: Very good. Now I know this is your first important job, so you ought to think about what it means to behave professionally.

Adam: Did I choose the wrong shoes?

Denise: No, you're fine. I mean things like you shouldn't spread gossip or accumulate absences. Mr. Brody told you about the importance of your attendance record?

Kristi: Yes, he did mention it.

Denise: Good.





Let's Practice!

Ms. Moore wants Adam and Kristi to have a smooth transition.

Instructions: Complete the sentences by underlining the correct answer.

1. Three people will **share** / **care** / **sure** this office space.
2. My job will be to make sure your **transit** / **tradition** / **transition** goes as smoothly and seamlessly as possible.
3. We want to build a trusting **work environment** / **work ethic environment** / **work environments**.
4. We don't want to always ask for **up dates** / **updates** / **upperdates**.
5. We strive to produce **tip quality** / **top qualities** / **top quality** publications.
6. We also expect you to be honest about your **progression** / **program** / **progress**.



Let's Practice!

Can you detect the minimal pairs in these sentences?

Instructions: Read the sentences aloud. Underline the minimal pairs within. Check your pronunciation and intonation with your instructor.

1. Please take this chair. We share furniture around here.
2. Three people will share this office. You have a lovely view of the tree outside.
3. Did I choose the wrong shoes?
4. You can buy potato chips on many ships.
5. I like to travel both by boat and by train.





Extension Activity

Find out about some company policies in large multinational corporations.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Choose 3 very large corporations, such as Disney, Apple Computers, eBay, etc.
- Go online. Find information about some policies in these companies. The policies can be related to hiring, marketing, attendance, etc.
- Choose 2 interesting policies for each company.
- Write a summary of the policies.
- With a partner, discuss the policies. Say what you think is good or not good about each one.

Self-Assessment

Yes

No

I read about policies in different companies.

☐ ☐

I write a summary of policies in different companies.

☐ ☐

I discuss my opinion of policies in different companies.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- **trusting** (adjective): inspiring confidence
e.g. We want to build a trusting work environment.
- **flexibility** (noun): the state of being flexible; able to easily make changes
e.g. There may be some flexibility, but as a rule of thumb, you should arrive before 9:00 a.m.
- **the exception rather than the rule** (expression): something that occurs rarely; that is not very common
e.g. As a rule of thumb, arriving after 9:00 should be the exception rather than the rule.
- **tête-à-tête** (noun): a private conversation, often on a sensitive or personal topic
e.g. I'd like to have a little tête-à-tête about some company policies.
- **transition** (noun): change from one status or condition to another
e.g. My job is to make sure your transition into the role of editorial assistants goes as smoothly and seamlessly as possible.





Learning Points

Minimal Pairs and Consonant Clusters

Minimal pairs are two words which sound the same, except for one sound. It is useful to practice saying minimal pairs to perfect your pronunciation of two sounds.

Consonant clusters are a group of 2 or more consonants that are pronounced together in one sound.

Let's look at minimal pairs comparing the sounds: **/sh/** and **/ch/** (consonant clusters) and **/th/** and **/t/**.

The sounds **/sh/** and **/ch/** are quite similar, except for the position of your lips and the length of the air flow.

Compare the two sounds. Say them out loud: **/sh/** and **/ch/**.

Now say these minimal pairs:

share	chair
shoes	choose

The sounds *th* and *t* are both unvoiced sounds. They are quite different in terms of the position of your teeth tongue.

Compare the two sounds. Say them out loud: **/th/** and **/t/**.

Now say these minimal pairs:

tree	three
boat	both

*Practice reading the following sentences from the text aloud. Focus on the pronunciation of the **/ch/**, **/sh/**, **/th/** and **/t/** sounds.*

Examples:

- *Three people will share this office. You have a lovely view of the tree outside.*
- *Please, take this chair. We share furniture around here.*





Learning Points

Modals to Express True and Possible: In my opinion, We should, Ought to

You use **should** and **ought to** to give your subjective opinion about whether you think something is possible or true.

For example:

*I've fixed the toilet and it **should** be working all right now.
You **ought to** wear that blue suit - it suits you!*

It is more common to use **should** and **ought to** when you give your opinion about whether something is right or not.

For example:

*You really **shouldn't** wear that - it is not flattering.
There **ought to** be a larger table in here - we can't work on that!*

Examples:

- *The counterpart of that means that you ought to be very reliable.*
- *Next, we should talk about establishing an appropriate work schedule.*
- *You shouldn't spread gossip or accumulate absences.*

